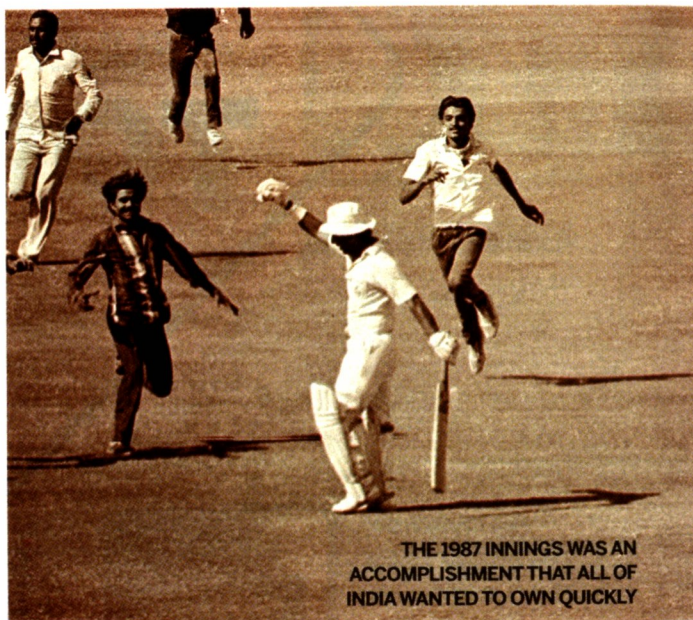


| 1987 | GAVASKAR IS THE FIRST TO SCORE 10,000 TEST RUNS

A 10 Tonne Toast

One small run made Indian cricketers believe they could be standard-bearers of excellence

Talk about small steps and giant leaps. On March 7, 1987, a quick single nudged through the slips to a Pakistani bowler named Ejaz Fakih took Sunil Manohar Gavaskar from his innings score of 57 to 58 at the Sardar Patel Stadium in rural Motera outside Ahmedabad. That run also took Gavaskar to a territory which, never mind the batsman, even cricket itself had never seen. Fifty seven to fifty eight sent Gavaskar from 9,999 to the first 10,000th run in Test cricket. Non-striker Kiran More says Gavaskar celebrated that moment like he usually didn't do in cricket. He sprinted. Or at least that's what it seemed like to millions watching tv because it was an accomplishment that all of India wanted to own quickly. So we believe that in that instant, this deliberate, determined Indian batsman was quicker than usual. His head slightly lowered, mid-single, Gavaskar raised his bat in both triumph and celebration. When he completed the run and reached the other end, Fakih was applauding as were the rest of the Pakistanis. He had wrung respect out of that hostile outfit for years and one was to even call him "Baba Aadam". As the news spread, the applause



KAMAL JULKA

THE 1987 INNINGS WAS AN ACCOMPLISHMENT THAT ALL OF INDIA WANTED TO OWN QUICKLY

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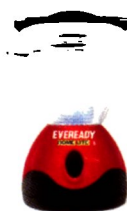
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